CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

WEDDING PLANNER IN THE AI ERA

The client is emotional, the budget is family money, and the deadline walks down an aisle — planners turn that pressure into a day that feels effortless.

★ TL;DR — Around $75K median for planners who build vendor trust and a portfolio over 1–6 months and a first season. The catch: your Saturdays belong to other people's love stories. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

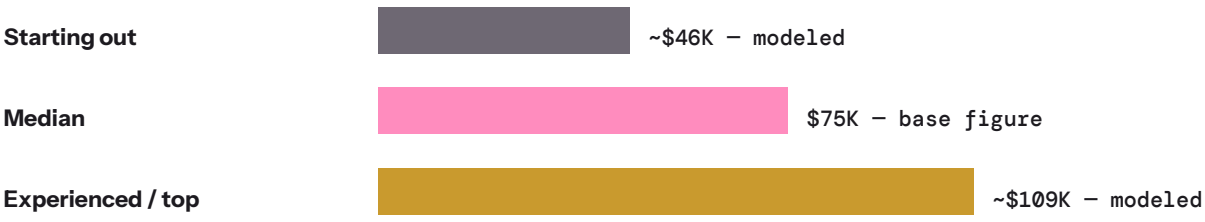
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Why it works: weddings are high-stakes, high-spend and happily outsourced by couples who want to enjoy their own day.
- Where it bites: family politics is an unlisted job duty, every single time.
- The AI angle: AI manages checklists and vendor emails — it cannot read a mother-in-law, fix a timeline in the rain or hold a bride's nerves together.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Wedding Planner is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A WEDDING PLANNER ACTUALLY DO?

✓ Build the wedding around a budget: venue, vendors, design, guests, flow

- ✓ Attend tastings, fittings and walkthroughs as the couple's professional
- ✓ Run rehearsal and the full wedding day from a minute-by-minute timeline
- ✓ Absorb problems before the couple ever hears about them

Think: a chief of staff for a one-day government made of flowers, feelings and family.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Planning platforms generate checklists, budgets, seating plans and vendor follow-ups. Client portals keep couples updated without the planner typing.	Judgment and presence are the job: vendor selection by taste, diplomacy between families, and invisible crisis work on the day. Couples buy trust with their most photographed day.

⚠ **You are the emotional shock absorber of the wedding industry. Boundaries and contracts protect you; vibes do not.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Beautiful rooms and genuinely happy clients ✓ Premium pricing for full-service planning ✓ Vendor community is tight and loyal	✗ Saturdays, all season, non-negotiable ✗ A year of planning lives in your head per client ✗ Tears — happy and otherwise — are a workplace material

Good fit? You are diplomatic, tireless on details, and can smile while quietly solving a disaster.
Bad fit? You take family drama personally, or you need your weekends back.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — ASSIST A WORKING PLANNER	DOOR B — DAY-OF COORDINATION FIRST
Wedding planners hire assistants for wedding days and prep. One season assisting teaches timelines, vendor etiquette and crisis craft better than any course — and busy planners hand off their overflow coordinations.	Sell month-of coordination: couples plan, you execute the final stretch and the day. It is the natural starter product — lower commitment for couples, fast portfolio and reviews for you.

Smart move: Become a venue's favorite coordinator. Venues recommend the planners who make their staff's lives easy — one venue relationship can fill a season.
Where you land after: A full-service planning studio with associate coordinators, or a signature niche — luxury, cultural or destination weddings.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN THE	BUILD YOUR	ASSIST A	SELL COORDINATIO	FIRST SOLO	GROW INTO

STEP 1 — Learn the wedding machine

FREE · WEEKS 1-3

- Vendor categories, standard timelines, budget anatomy
- Shadow or assist at two weddings before selling anything

STEP 2 — Build your vendor map

MONTHS 1-2

- Venues first, then photographers, florists, caterers, DJs
- Know prices and personalities, not just Instagram pages

STEP 3 — Assist a full season start

PAID · MONTHS 1-4

- Wedding-day assisting under established planners
- Learn the run-sheet discipline and crisis etiquette

STEP 4 — Sell coordination packages

MONTHS 2-4

- Month-of coordination as your entry product
- Contracts, deposits and a clear scope — always

STEP 5 — First solo weddings

MONTHS 4-6

- Run your booked days flawlessly; document everything
- Reviews from couples and vendors both count

STEP 6 — Grow into full planning

MONTH 6+

- Full-service clients come from proven coordination
- Raise prices as your season fills a year out

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- Today: write the full vendor list and timeline of a wedding you have attended.
- Days 1–30: line up assisting dates; start your venue and vendor map.
- Days 31–60: assist on real wedding days; build coordination packages and contracts.
- Days 61–90: book your first coordination clients for the coming season.
- Day 90: a working coordinator with venue friends — full planning clients follow the proof.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **EFFORTLESS IS PLANNED.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.